

# MARISSA E. THOMPSON

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Social Stratification • Sociology of Education • Race & Ethnicity • Public Policy

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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| <b>Columbia University</b><br>Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology<br>Co-Director, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality<br>Faculty Affiliate, Columbia Population Research Center<br>Faculty Affiliate, Data Science Institute | 2022-present |
| <b>University of Michigan</b><br>Postdoctoral Fellow, Education Policy Initiative, Ford School of Public Policy<br>Research Affiliate, Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics                                                                     | 2021-2022    |

## EDUCATION

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| <b>Ph.D., Sociology of Education &amp; Education Policy</b><br>Stanford University                           | 2021 |
| <b>M.A., Sociology</b><br>Stanford University                                                                | 2019 |
| <b>B.S.E., Chemical and Biomolecular Engineering</b><br><i>magna cum laude</i><br>University of Pennsylvania | 2016 |

## PUBLICATIONS

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\* denotes joint lead authorship, ^ denotes student co-author

### Peer-Reviewed Publications:

- Forth.* **Marissa E. Thompson**, AJ Alvero, Sam Trejo and Daphne O. Martschenko. “*What does it mean to be Black?: Experimental evidence on the situational deployment of racial schemas.*” Forthcoming at *Sociology of Race and Ethnicity*.
- 2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sam Trejo, AJ Alvero, and Daphne O. Martschenko. “Policing the boundaries of Blackness: How Black and White Americans evaluate racial self-identifications.” *American Journal of Sociology*. [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]
- 2026 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “‘Paper, practice, ancestry, culture’: Racial frames and contested racial/ethnic census categories.” *Social Forces*. [Paper]
- 2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Tobias Dalberg, and Elizabeth E. Bruch. “Gender Segregation and Decision-Making in Undergraduate Course-Taking.” *Sociological Science*. [Paper] [Data/Code]
- 2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “The Effect of Academic Outcomes, Equity, and Student

Demographics on Parental Preferences for Schools: Evidence from a Survey Experiment.” *Social Forces*. [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]

- Best Post-PhD Paper Award (Co-Winner), Sociology of Education Association, 2025

- 2024 **Marissa E. Thompson\*** and Sam Trejo\*. “My School District Isn’t Segregated: Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Information on Parental Preferences Regarding School Segregation.” *Sociology of Education*. [Paper] [Data/Code] [Pre-Registration]
- 2024 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Examining the Black Gender Gap in Educational Attainment: The Role of Exclusionary School Discipline & Criminal Justice Contact.” *Social Forces*. [Paper]
- 2023 **Marissa E. Thompson**, Christina Weiland, Meghan P. McCormick, Catherine Snow, and Jason Sachs. “The Role of Early Schooling in Shaping Inequality in Academic, Executive Functioning, and Social-Emotional Skills.” *Socius*. [Paper]
- 2023 René F. Kizilcec, Rachel B. Baker, Elizabeth Bruch, Kalena E. Cortes, Laura T. Hamilton, David Nathan Lang, Zachary A. Pardos, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Mitchell L. Stevens. “From Pipelines to Pathways in the Study of Academic Progress.” *Science (Policy Forum)*. [Paper]
- 2023 Kaylee T. Matheny\*, **Marissa E. Thompson\***, Carrie Townley-Flores\*, and Sean F. Reardon. “Uneven Progress: Recent Trends in Academic Performance Among U.S. School Districts.” *American Educational Research Journal*. [Paper]
- 2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Grade Expectations: The Role of First-Year Grades in Predicting the Pursuit of STEM Majors for First- and Continuing-Generation Students.” *The Journal of Higher Education*. [Paper]
- 2021 Sorathan Chaturapruek, Tobias Dalberg, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Sonia Giebel, Monique H. Harrison, Ramesh Johari, Mitchell L. Stevens, and René Kizilcec. “Studying Undergraduate Course Consideration at Scale.” *AERA Open*. [Paper] [Data/Code]
- 2020 Adina D. Sterling, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Shiya Wang, Abisola Kusimo, Shannon Gilmartin, and Sheri Sheppard. “The Confidence Gap Predicts the Gender Pay Gap Among STEM Graduates.” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. [Paper]
- 2019 Shannon Gilmartin, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Emily Morton, Helen Chen, Anne Colby, and Sheri Sheppard. “Entrepreneurial Intent of Engineering and Business Undergraduate Students.” *Journal of Engineering Education*. [Paper]
- 2016 Ki Jun Yu, Duygu Kuzum, Suk Won Hwang, Bong Hoon Kim, Halvor Juul, Nam Heon Kim, Sang Min Won, Ken Chiang, Michael Trumpis, Andrew G. Richardson, Huanyu Cheng, Hui Fang, **Marissa E. Thompson**, Hank Bink, Delia Talos, Kyung Jin Seo, Hee Nam Lee, Seung Kyun Kang, Jae Hwan Kim, Jung Yup Lee, Younggang Huang, Frances E. Jensen, Marc A. Dichter, Timothy H. Lucas, Jonathan Viveni, Brian Litt, and John A. Rogers. “Bioresorbable Silicon Electronics for Transient Spatiotemporal Mapping of Electrical Activity from the Cerebral Cortex.” *Nature Materials*. [Paper]

### Working Papers & Manuscripts Under Review:

**Marissa E. Thompson**, Sam Trejo, AJ Alvero, and Daphne O. Martschenko. “‘Being Black is Not Just Some Costume’: How Black Americans narrate moral judgments regarding racial boundary-crossing.” Conditionally accepted at *Social Problems*.

Elizabeth Burland, Jasmina Camo Biogralija, Xavier Fields<sup>^</sup>, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson<sup>^</sup>, Katherine Michelmores, Megan Tompkins Stange, Kevin Stange, Nathan Sotherland<sup>^</sup>, and **Marissa E.**

**Thompson** (authorship alphabetical). “Bureaucrats and Burden: Understanding Variation in Take-up of a Need-Based Aid Program.” Revise & resubmit, *American Educational Research Journal*. [Working Paper]

Sam Trejo and **Marissa E. Thompson**. “DNA Reveals the Growing Ancestral Diversity of the United States.” Under Review. [Working Paper]

**Marissa E. Thompson**, Katherine Micheltmore, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson<sup>^</sup>, Nathan Sotherland<sup>^</sup>, Kevin Stange. “One Fell Through the Safety Net: Embeddedness and Take Up of Social Benefits.” Under Review.

Adina D. Sterling, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Devon Rojas<sup>^</sup>. “When Employer Commitment Does (Not) Produce Racialized Effects in Hiring.” Under Review.

## Policy Briefs & Other Publications:

- 2026 Kevin Stange, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson, Margaret Peterman, Nelson Oviedo, Nathan Sotherland, Nicole Wagner Lam, **Marissa E. Thompson**, and Katherine Micheltmore. “The Effectiveness of Need-Based Financial Aid: Evidence from Michigan’s Tuition Incentive Program.” EPI Policy Brief. [Link]
- 2024 Kelcie Gerson, Katherine Micheltmore, Nathan Sotherland, Kevin Stange, and **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Michigan’s Tuition Incentive Program: An Initial Look at Take-up.” EPI Policy Brief. [Link]
- 2021 **Marissa E. Thompson**. “Who’s getting pulled in weed-out courses for STEM majors?” Brown Center Chalkboard, Brookings Institution. [Link]

## GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |           |
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| Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Academy of Education & Spencer Foundation – \$70,000                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2024-2025 |
| Russell Sage Foundation & Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation Pipeline Grant – \$35,000<br>for “ <i>What is fair? Disentangling public conceptions of merit and equity in the age of inequality</i> ”<br>P.I. Marissa Thompson                                                   | 2024      |
| Hettelman Junior Faculty Summer Research Grant, Columbia University – \$6,000                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2024      |
| Alliance Joint Projects Grant, Columbia University & Sciences Po (Paris) – \$15,000<br>for “ <i>A Columbia-Sciences Po Joint Course: Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic</i> ”<br>P.I.s Thomas DiPrete, Mirna Safi & Marissa Thompson  | 2023      |
| Columbia Population Research Center Seed Grant, Columbia University – \$20,000<br>for “ <i>Race, Genetic Ancestry, and Context: Exploring How Genetic Ancestry Tests Influence Conceptions of Race</i> ”<br>P.I.s Marissa Thompson, Sam Trejo, Daphne Martschenko, & AJ Alvero | 2022      |
| Institute of Education Sciences (IES) Grant – \$2,702,034<br>for “ <i>Early First-Dollar Categorical Need-Based Aid: A New Model for Making College Affordable?</i> ”<br>P.I. Kevin Stange                                                                                     | 2022-2026 |
| Postdoctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – \$55,000                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2021-2022 |

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| Center for American Democracy Grant, Stanford University – \$2,000<br>for “ <i>Understanding Parental Attitudes Towards School Segregation</i> ”<br>P.I.s Marissa Thompson and Sam Trejo | 2020-2021 |
| Karr Family Fellowship, Stanford University – \$19,000                                                                                                                                   | 2018-2019 |
| Predoctoral Training Fellowship, Institute of Education Sciences (IES) – \$60,000                                                                                                        | 2017-2019 |
| Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering, Stanford University – \$125,100                                                                                                          | 2016-2021 |
| Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education Fellowship, Stanford University – \$12,800                                                                                                     | 2016-2021 |

## HONORS & AWARDS

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| Best Post-PhD Paper (Co-Winner), Sociology of Education Association                            | 2025 |
| Outstanding Predoctoral Fellow Award, Institute of Education Sciences (IES)                    | 2021 |
| Zeisberg Best Research Award in Chemical Engineering, American Institute of Chemical Engineers | 2017 |
| Melvin C. Molstad Prize in Chemical Engineering, University of Pennsylvania                    | 2016 |
| Exceptional Service Award, University of Pennsylvania                                          | 2016 |

## RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

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| <b>Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)</b><br>Invited Researcher                             | 2025-2028    |
| <b>University of Chicago</b><br>Affiliate, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility | 2023-2027    |
| <b>Stanford University</b><br>Affiliate, Pathways Network                                              | 2021-present |

## TEACHING

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| <b>Columbia University</b><br>The Social World – Introduction to Sociology (Undergraduate): Spring 2026<br>Education and Inequality (Undergraduate): Spring 2024, Spring 2026<br>Race, Discrimination, and Racial Inequalities on Both Sides of the Atlantic (Undergraduate): Fall 2023, Fall 2025<br>Sociology of Education (Graduate): Fall 2022<br>Workshop on Wealth and Inequality (Graduate): Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2024 |  |
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## INVITED PRESENTATIONS

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(includes scheduled presentations)

|      |                                                                                                                            |
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| 2027 | University of Texas at Austin, Population Research Center                                                                  |
| 2026 | RC-28 Thematic Meeting on Educational Inequalities (Keynote)<br>University of California Berkeley, Department of Sociology |

University of Pennsylvania, Graduate School of Education  
Purdue University, Department of Sociology  
University of Notre Dame, Center for Research on Educational Opportunity

- 2025 University of California Los Angeles, California Center for Population Research  
Brown University, Annenberg Institute  
Princeton University, Office of Population Research  
Princeton University, Education Research Section  
Vanderbilt University, Peabody Education Policy Seminar Series  
Sciences Po Paris, Centre for Research on Social Inequalities  
New York University, Sociology of Culture Workshop
- 2024 University of Pennsylvania, Population Studies Center  
ENSAE Paris, Center for Research in Economics and Statistics  
Sciences Po Paris, Centre for Research on Social Inequalities  
University of Chicago, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility  
University of Oxford, Classical and Computational Social Science Working Group  
Stanford University, Center for Education Policy Analysis  
Stanford University, Educational Opportunity Project & Institute for Advancing Just Societies
- 2023 University of Michigan, Center for Academic Innovation  
University of Houston, Identity & Academic Motivation Lab  
Columbia University, Population Research Center  
Pennsylvania State University, Population Research Institute  
Yale University, Center for Empirical Research on Stratification and Inequality  
University of Wisconsin - Madison, Wisconsin Center for Educational Research  
University of Wisconsin - Madison, Experimental Methods in Sociology Workshop
- 2022 Columbia University, Center for the Study of Wealth and Inequality  
Drexel University, Pennoni Honors College (Panel)  
Pennsylvania State University, College of Education  
Columbia University, Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences Research Seminar
- 2021 University of Michigan, Ford School of Public Policy  
Howard University, School of Education  
University of Florida, College of Education  
Columbia University, Department of Sociology
- 2020 École Normale Supérieure, Département d'Études Cognitives

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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(includes scheduled presentations)

- 2026 RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility (Seville, Spain)  
*Sociological Science* Conference (Stanford, CA)  
American Sociological Association (New York, NY)
- 2025 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)  
Population Association of America (Washington, D.C.)  
*Sociological Science* Conference (Ithaca, NY)
- 2024 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)  
American Sociological Association (Montreal, Canada)

Race & Ancestry Symposium (University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA)

- 2023 Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)  
Population Association of America (New Orleans, LA)  
RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility (Paris, France)  
American Sociological Association (Philadelphia, PA)
- 2022 American Sociological Association (Los Angeles, CA)  
Association of Black Sociologists (Chicago, IL)
- 2021 American Sociological Association (Virtual)  
Association for Education Finance and Policy (Virtual)  
Empowering Learners in AI (Virtual)
- 2020 Association for the Study of Higher Education (Virtual)
- 2019 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Denver, CO)  
Sociology of Education Association (Pacific Grove, CA)  
Association for Education Finance and Policy (Kansas City, MO)  
American Sociological Association (New York, NY)
- 2018 American Society of Engineering Education (Salt Lake City, UT)  
American Sociological Association (Philadelphia, PA)

## DEPARTMENTAL & UNIVERSITY SERVICE

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| Graduate Admissions Committee, Columbia University                   | 2023, 2026 |
| Graduate & Undergraduate Thesis Prize Committee, Columbia University | 2024       |

### Student Advising:

#### *PhD Dissertation Committee*

Katerine Perez (Sociology, Columbia University, in progress)  
Eva Chen (Sociology, Columbia University, in progress)  
Elizabeth Adetiba (Sociology, Columbia University, 2025)  
Bonnie Siegler (Sociology, Columbia University, 2025)  
Dominic Walker (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)  
Asya Tsaturyan (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)  
Abbey Keener (Education, Columbia University, 2024)  
Taylor Alexander (Education, University of Houston, 2023)

#### *MA Thesis Advising*

Kayla Smernoff (Sociology, Columbia University, 2026)  
Amita Khurana (Sociology, Columbia University, 2024)

#### *Undergraduate Advising*

Gulnazik Bakhramova (Harriman Institute Summer Research Fellowship, Columbia University, 2026)  
Kelly Yoshimura (Laidlaw Summer Program, Columbia University, 2023 & 2024)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

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|                                                                                   |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Program Committee, Eastern Sociological Society Annual Meeting                    | 2027      |
| Council Member, ASA Section on Inequality, Poverty, & Mobility                    | 2026-2029 |
| Editorial Board, <i>Sociology of Education</i>                                    | 2026-2029 |
| Outstanding Student Publication Award Committee, ASA Section on Biology & Society | 2026      |
| Council Member, ASA Section on Biology & Society                                  | 2025-2026 |
| Participatory Budgeting Committee, ASA Section on Inequality, Poverty, & Mobility | 2025-2026 |

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| Nominations Committee, ASA Section on Sociology of Education        | 2025-2026 |
| Fall Conference Program Chair, Sociology of Education Association   | 2024      |
| Session Organizer, PAA Annual Meeting                               | 2024      |
| Board of Directors, Sociology of Education Association              | 2023-2025 |
| Outstanding Publication Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology | 2023      |
| Clifford Clogg Award Committee, ASA Section on Methodology          | 2022      |
| Council Member (Student), ASA Section on Methodology                | 2021-2023 |

### **Professional Association Memberships:**

American Sociological Association (ASA)  
 Association of Black Sociologists (ABS)  
 Population Association of America (PAA)  
 RC-28: Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility  
 Sociology of Education Association (SEA)

### **Occasional Reviewer:**

*AERA Open, American Educational Research Journal, American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, European Sociological Review, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, J-PAL North America Grants, Peabody Journal of Education, Social Currents, Social Forces, Social Science Research, Sociological Focus, Sociological Science, Sociology of Education, Socius, The Journal of Higher Education, Time-Sharing Experiments in the Social Sciences (TESS) Grants*